

[BACK](#)

A Lively and Engaging Look at Disability Inclusion and Accessibility



By [David Paradela](#) Internal Communications Associate - Mon, Jul 10, 2023 11:00 AM

- [Aly Criscuolo](#) + 6

NYRR has long been known for its efforts to make its races as inclusive as possible to individuals with disabilities, dating back to 1976, when [Dick Traum became the first known amputee athlete to complete a marathon](#) (and it happened in New York City!).

But there's always room for us to grow as an organization, learn the history, policies, and barriers to disability inclusion, and implement broader accessibility measures and tools for everyone at our races and our workspaces. In our efforts to continue to learn and grow, [Marc Guillaume](#), NYRR Director of Disability Inclusion and Accessibility, led a Lunch & Learn on Thursday, June 22 to provide an overview of disability inclusion and accessibility while helping staff learn about the field in a lively and engaging manner.

"These conversations are probably more uncomfortable for people without disabilities than for someone that has one," said Guillaume on his process of developing the presentation. Therefore, he planned the presentation with the idea of "incorporating some type of fun while learning" through games, audience participation, and volunteers to illustrate his points. Staffers played BINGO and Jeopardy to demonstrate their knowledge of disability inclusion and accessibility, and one brave volunteer even went up to try to translate braille to English.

Guillaume's deep knowledge of the disability inclusion and accessibility fields showed at the Lunch and Learn as he took NYRR staff through the fundamentals of disability at the federal, state, and city levels, etiquette and language best practices around disability, various categories of disabilities and barriers, and common misconceptions about disabilities. Staff members were viewed listening attentively as the information provided during the presentation session was informative and engaging.

On any upcoming initiatives around disability inclusion and accessibility at NYRR, Guillaume mentioned, "each of us has specialized roles in the organization, and believe it or not, accessibility plays a role in every one of them. There are task-specific trainings available and upcoming as well as accessibility guidelines currently available. NYRR offers support and opportunities to learn—if you're interested and if you're willing."

You can find the PDF of Marc's Lunch and Learn presentation [here](#).

Write something, paste links, or upload images



Write a comment

